Records Pause

S&P −0.38% from Wednesday's all-time high. AI cohort takes a breather. FTNT +20.03% on Q1 blowout. NVDA bucks the give-back ahead of May 20.

THE SESSION

The records held, but barely. The S&P 500 closed at 7,337.11, down 0.38% from Wednesday's all-time high; the Nasdaq slipped 0.13% to 25,806.20 after also setting a fresh record intraday; the Dow surrendered 313.62 points to 49,596.96 (−0.63%); the Russell 2000 led the give-back at −1.63%. Sixteen S&P 500 names still printed all-time highs during the session, including CAT, Apple, Alphabet, Cummins, and Fortinet — the broader breadth picture remains constructive even on a red day.

The principal driver was the AI cohort taking a breather after Wednesday's coordinated revaluation of the physical-AI infrastructure stack. AMD (−3.07% to $408.46) gave back a small fraction of its 18.61% Wednesday surge; LRCX (−3.58%), NXPI (−4.39%), KEYS (−3.17%), and TEL (−2.83%) followed the same pattern. The give-back was orderly, not a reversal — this is what consolidation in an AI-led rally looks like. NVDA bucked the tape entirely, advancing 1.77% to $211.50 with its May 20 print thirteen days out and AMD's blowout having materially eased the bar.

Iran headlines and oil stayed in motion. CNN reported Iran was evaluating the U.S. fourteen-point framework with a response possible Thursday; Trump signaled the war would 'be over quickly' in his characterization. Brent crude reversed off intraday lows below $100, settling at $100.06 (−1.19%); WTI finished at $94.81 (−0.28%). The energy sleeve mostly stabilized after Wednesday's collapse: VLO essentially flat at −0.14%, OKE +0.32%, CVX −1.44%. Initial jobless claims came in at 200K against a 205K consensus per the Labor Department release, productivity rose 0.8% versus 1.1% expected, and unit labor costs rose 2.3%. The labor backdrop remains tight ahead of Friday's non-farm payrolls.

IOWN Tactical: SPY at 7,337 sits roughly 13.6% above Carson's active level of $645.80. No tactical trigger today — a 0.38% pullback from a record close is consolidation, not weakness. The TRIM signal remains valid above the 200DMA and the BUY tranches sit far below current levels. The committee continues to hold positioning.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

FTNT +20.03% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Q1 EPS of $0.82 versus $0.62 consensus per the company release — a 32% earnings surprise. Revenue $1.85B (+20% YoY), product revenue +41% to $645M, billings +31% to $2.09B. Management raised full-year 2026 revenue guidance to $7.71B–$7.87B (versus prior $7.50B–$7.70B) and EPS to $3.10–$3.16 (versus prior $2.94–$3.00). Closed at $107.97.

QCOM +5.18% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Continued momentum from the April 29 Q2 print: $2.65 EPS on $10.6B revenue, with automotive revenue +38% YoY and the Snapdragon Digital Chassis platform now at a $5B annualized run rate. Closed at $202.55 — the AI-edge and hyperscaler-data-center optionality is now being priced in alongside the established licensing base.

ADP +3.33% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $214.09 ahead of Friday's non-farm payrolls. Initial jobless claims printed 200K against a 205K consensus per Labor Department data, supporting the steady-labor-market narrative that benefits the payroll-processing franchise.

NVDA +1.77% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bucked the broader semiconductor give-back, closing at $211.50 with the May 20 earnings print thirteen days out. AMD's Wednesday blowout materially reduced the bar NVDA needs to clear, and the day's relative strength suggests positioning is being rebuilt rather than trimmed into the print.

BKH +1.76% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $75.22, recovering from Tuesday's post-print pullback. The reaffirmed 2026 guidance and updates on the NorthWestern merger and data-center pipeline continue to support the regulated-utility setup.

DGX +0.90% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $190.84 — a steady defensive bid in a session where rate-sensitive names were mixed and cyclicals weakened.

DECLINERS

NTR –7.36% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $68.38 after reporting Q1 results Wednesday after close: $0.51 adjusted EPS versus $0.48 consensus, revenue $6.05B versus $5.36B expected per the company release. Despite the headline beat, the post-print conference call and full-year setup pressured shares as the fertilizer cohort absorbed the agricultural cyclical weakness.

HUT –7.12% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gave back a portion of Wednesday's 35.31% surge, closing at $101.18. Bitcoin slipped 1.59% to $80,127 against a session that had tagged $82K Wednesday — the miner cohort is reverting to spot direction after the operational-leverage repricing.

STLD –3.69% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $232.92 in a session where the broader steel and industrial cyclical complex weakened. CAT (−3.37%) and PCAR (−2.11%) followed the same pattern.

LRCX –3.58% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $286.52, giving back roughly half of Wednesday's 7.75% surge. The semiconductor-equipment names that ripped on the AMD-Meta-Instinct read-through are consolidating as the AI-infrastructure cohort takes a breather.

CAT –3.37% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at $895.69 in a session where Caterpillar still printed at all-time-high levels intraday per CNBC's tracking of S&P 500 components touching records. The pullback is from the highs, not from the trend.

HOOD –3.50% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at $76.28 as the digital-asset and crypto-trading cohort softened with Bitcoin. COIN finished −2.53% in sympathy.

AMD –3.07% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at $408.46 — a small give-back relative to Wednesday's 18.61% post-earnings surge. The Meta 6 GW Instinct commitment and Q2 guide above $11.2B remain the structural anchors; today's move is profit-taking, not thesis change.

VST –2.74% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at $153.95 ahead of its earnings release after the close. The AI-power thesis on Vistra remains the principal forward marker on the physical-AI generation side.

HOLDINGS NEWS

FTNT raised full-year 2026 guidance. Per the GlobeNewswire release Wednesday after close, Fortinet guided FY2026 revenue to $7.71B–$7.87B (prior $7.50B–$7.70B), non-GAAP operating margin to 33%–36%, and non-GAAP EPS to $3.10–$3.16 (prior $2.94–$3.00). Q2 revenue is guided to $1.83B–$1.93B with non-GAAP EPS $0.72–$0.76. Operating cash flow hit a record $1.08B and free cash flow a record $1.01B. Mizuho raised its target to $86 while maintaining Underperform; Arete flipped to Buy with a $104 target.

NTR reported Q1 ahead of the conference call. Per the BusinessWire release, Nutrien posted $139M net earnings ($0.27 GAAP diluted EPS, $0.51 adjusted EPS) and $1.11B adjusted EBITDA on $6.05B revenue. CEO Ken Seitz cited record potash sales volumes and a 98% nitrogen ammonia operating rate. Despite the beat versus the $0.48 EPS consensus, shares finished down 7.36% as the market processed the call.

CTRA exited the S&P 500. Veeva Systems replaced Coterra Energy in the index ahead of Thursday's open per S&P Dow Jones Indices, with Devon Energy continuing as the surviving constituent. CTRA shareholders received 0.70 Devon shares per CTRA share at the close. The Permian-consolidation thesis carries forward into the larger Devon production base.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

–1.67%

vs. DVY –0.97% | SPY –0.31%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

–1.42%

vs. IUSG –0.19%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +12.00% vs DVY +8.01% / SPY +7.28%

Growth +8.94% vs IUSG +9.22%

Both strategies trailed on the day. Dividend at −1.67% trailed DVY (−0.97%) and SPY (−0.31%) on heavy hits to NTR, STLD, LRCX, and CAT. Growth at −1.42% trailed IUSG (−0.19%) on the AI-cohort give-back; FTNT's 20.03% surge partially offset but could not overcome the breadth of the semiconductor pullback. Year-to-date positioning remains strong: Dividend +12.00% beats DVY (+8.01%) by 399 bps and SPY (+7.28%) by 472 bps; Growth +8.94% trails IUSG (+9.22%) by 28 bps. The Dividend Strategy's YTD lead is structural — built on owning the right businesses through volatility rather than on any single catalyst.